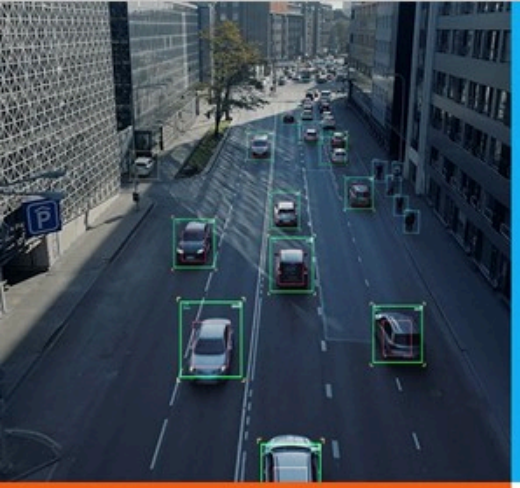

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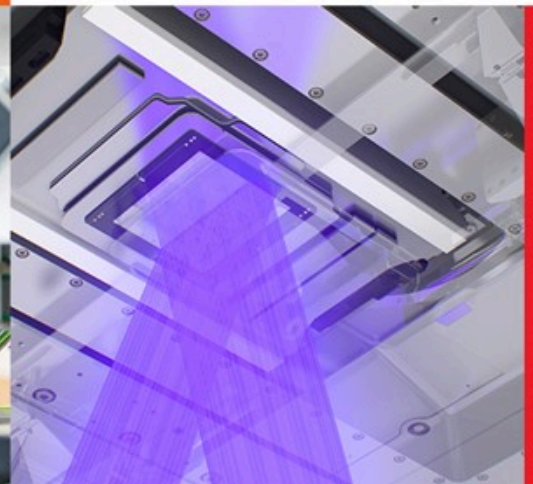

SOFTWARE

C++ Training

Coroutines

Async

- Waiting on external resources
  - Network calls
  - Disk I/O
  - Timers
- CPU mostly idle while waiting
- avoid blocking threads

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Traditional Async APIs

- State is split across lambdas / function objects
- User manages lifetime manually
- Error-prone and hard to follow

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Callback hell

```
socket.async_read(buf1, [this](error_code ec, size_t n) {
    if (!ec) {
        socket.async_read(buf2, [this](error_code ec, size_t n) {
            if (!ec) {
                process(buf1, buf2);
            }
        });
    }
});
```

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Traditional Async APIs

- Nested lambdas
- Manual error handling at each level
- Lifetimes must be carefully managed
- Hard to reason about program flow

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Lifetime issue

Local variable captured by reference

```
void foo(tcp::socket& socket)
{
    std::string msg = "hello";

    socket.async_write_some(
        buffer(msg),
        [&](auto ec, auto len)
        {
            log("sent " + msg);   // <-- BUG
        });
}
```

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Wrong usage of shared_ptr

```
class Session : public std::enable_shared_from_this<Session>
{
public:
    void start()
    {
        //auto self = shared_from_this();
        socket_.async_read_some(
            boost::asio::buffer(buffer_),
            [this](error_code ec, size_t n)
            {
                if (!ec)
                    handle_data(n);
            });
    }
};
auto session = std::make_shared<Session>(...);
session->start();
```

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Coroutines

- “pause” the function and resume when data arrives
- keeps logic linear
- no callbacks
- no lifetime management

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C++ Coroutine

- a function
- can suspend execution
- resume from the suspension point
- maintains state across suspends
- Stackless
  - No dedicated stack
  - Suspension points explicit
  - Locals stored on the heap
  - More lightweight
  - Compiler transforms the function

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C++ Coroutine

Other languages (Python, C#, Rust async, etc.) often imply scheduling semantics when you await.
But in C++20:

- no runtime scheduler
- a coroutine ≈ compiler-generated state machines

This is **key** to understand a lot of otherwise confusing looking syntax

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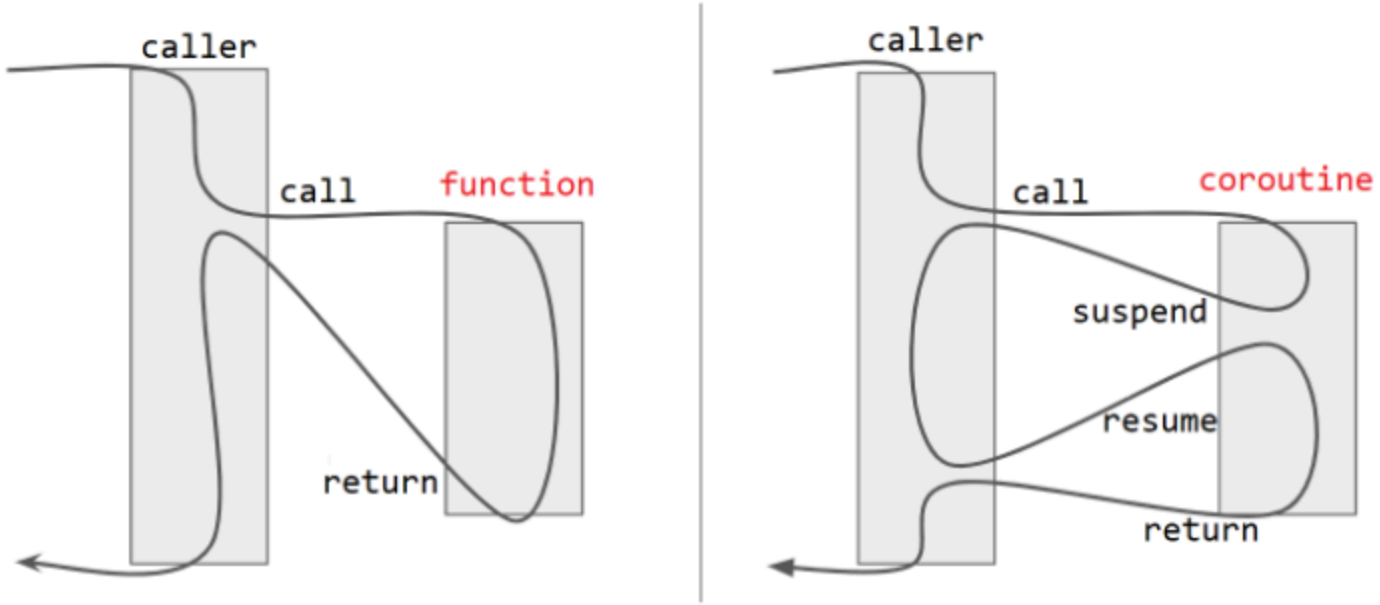
Coroutine flow



https://vishalchovatiya.com/posts/cpp20-coroutine-under-the-hood/

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Where Is the coroutine state stored?

- Compiler rewrites the function
- Creates a state machine object
- Local variables become fields
- stack frame becomes heap-allocated state(!)

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Coroutines:

- async operations written as normal code
- automatic lifetime handling
- clearer control flow
- efficient I/O-bound concurrency

New language keywords:

- co_yield
- co_return
- co_await

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co_yield , co_return

```
Generator<int> count_to_three()
{
    int v = 0;
    co_yield ++v; //suspend
    co_yield ++v; //suspend
    co_yield ++v; //suspend
    co_return;   // signals completion (optional but explicit)
}

int main()
{
    //resume, suspend
    for (int value : count_to_three())
        std::cout << value << "\n";
}
```

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```
template<typename T>
struct Generator {
    struct promise_type;
    using handle_type = std::coroutine_handle<promise_type>;
    struct promise_type {
        std::optional<T> current_value;
        Generator get_return_object() {
            return Generator{handle_type::from_promise(*this)};
        }
        std::suspend_always initial_suspend() { return {}; }
        std::suspend_always final_suspend() noexcept { return {}; }
        std::suspend_always yield_value(T value) {
            current_value = value;
            return {};
        }
        void return_void() {}     // used when co_return; is called
        void unhandled_exception() { std::terminate(); }
    };
    handle_type handle;
    explicit Generator(handle_type h) : handle(h) {}
    ~Generator() { if (handle) handle.destroy(); }
    struct Iterator
    {
        handle_type handle;
        bool done;
        void operator++() {
            handle.resume();
            done = handle.done();
        }
        T const& operator*() const {
            return *handle.promise().current_value;
        }
        bool operator!=(std::default_sentinel_t) const {
            return !done;
        }
    };
    Iterator begin() {
        handle.resume();
        return Iterator{handle, handle.done()};
    }
    std::default_sentinel_t end() {
        return {};
    }
};
```

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promise_type

When the compiler sees a function that uses:

- co_await
- co_yield
- co_return

it transforms the function into a state machine object, called the coroutine frame.

That frame contains an instance of:

```
ReturnType::promise_type
```

the compiler looks up:

```
Generator<int>::promise_type
```

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promise_type is the interface between user code and compiler generated state machine

```
Caller calls coroutine()
        ↓
Coroutine frame allocated (heap usually)
        ↓
ReturnType::promise_type constructed
        ↓
ReturnType::promise_type::initial_suspend()
        ↓
body executes
        ↓
co_yield (ReturnType::promise_type::yield_value)
        ↓
ReturnType::promise_type::final_suspend()
        ↓
destroy frame
```

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initial_suspend

Controls whether the coroutine runs immediately, or starts suspended

- std::suspend_never
- std::suspend_always

Required? Yes

Why customize?

- Generators normally start suspended so the caller decides when to run:
- Tasks often start immediately instead.

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final_suspend

Controls behavior after the coroutine reaches the end or co_return.

Most commonly: std::suspend_always

Required? Yes.

- the caller has a chance to observe completion
- destroy the coroutine frame in a controlled way

Why customize?

- Generators usually suspend
- Tasks may notify taskmanager of completion

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yield_value(T value)

This is called whenever the coroutine hits: co_yield something; stores the yielded value; schedules suspension

Required?

Required for generators,
Not required for coroutines that never use co_yield.

Why customize?

- how values are stored (reference vs copy, lifetime)
- buffering
- ownership/lifetime

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return_void() / return_value(T)

One of these must exist.

Called when: co_return ;

(or end of function)

Required?

Yes — one of them.

return_void() → void coroutine result

return_value(T) → T result

Why customize?

final output

completion signaling

error states

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unhandled_exception()

Called if the coroutine body throws an exception that is not caught inside the coroutine

Required? Yes.

Typical behavior:

store exception

rethrow on resume

terminate

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return_xxxx vs final_suspend

They solve different problems:

- Deliver the coroutine's final result: return_value / return_void
- Decide whether to suspend before destruction: final_suspend
  logical completion vs lifecycle control

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C++23 introduced added a similar generator to the library

```
#include <generator>
#include <iostream>
std::generator<int> count()
{
    for (int i = 1; i <= 3; ++i)
        co_yield i;

    co_return;
}
int main()
{
    for (int v : count())
        std::cout << v << "\n";
}
```

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```cpp
#include <coroutine>
#include <print>
#include <thread>
#include <memory>
struct Generator {
    struct promise_type;
    using handle_type = std::coroutine_handle<promise_type>;

    handle_type coro;

    Generator(handle_type h) : coro(h) {
        std::println("[Thread {}] Generator constructed", std::this_thread::get_id());
    }

    ~Generator() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] Generator destroyed", std::this_thread::get_id());
        if (coro) coro.destroy();
    }

    bool next() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] next(): calling resume()", std::this_thread::get_id());
        coro.resume();
        std::println("[Thread {}] next(): resume() returned", std::this_thread::get_id());

        return !coro.done();
    }

    int value();
};
```

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C++23 spec: 9.5.4 coroutine definitions

```
An implementation may need to allocate additional storage for a coroutine. This storage is known as the
coroutine state and is obtained by calling a non-array allocation function (6.7.5.5.2). The allocation function’s name is looked up by searching for it in **the scope of the promise type**.
```

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```cpp
struct Generator::promise_type
{
    int current_value{};
    static void* operator new(std::size_t sz) {
        std::println("[Thread {}] [operator new] Allocating coroutine frame of size {} bytes",
            std::this_thread::get_id(), sz);
        return std::malloc(sz);
    }
    static void operator delete(void* ptr, std::size_t sz) {
        std::println("[Thread {}] [operator delete] Freeing coroutine frame of size {} bytes",
            std::this_thread::get_id(), sz);
        std::free(ptr);
    }

    promise_type() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] promise_type constructed", std::this_thread::get_id());
    }
    ~promise_type() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] promise_type destroyed", std::this_thread::get_id());
    }
    Generator get_return_object() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] get_return_object()", std::this_thread::get_id());
        return Generator{ handle_type::from_promise(*this) };
    }
    std::suspend_always initial_suspend() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] initial_suspend()", std::this_thread::get_id());
        return {};
    }
    std::suspend_always final_suspend() noexcept {
        std::println("[Thread {}] final_suspend()", std::this_thread::get_id());
        return {};
    }
    std::suspend_always yield_value(int v) {
        std::println("[Thread {}] yield_value({})", std::this_thread::get_id(), v);
        current_value = v;
        return {};
    }
    void return_void() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] return_void()", std::this_thread::get_id());
    }
    void unhandled_exception() {
        std::println("[Thread {}] unhandled_exception()", std::this_thread::get_id());
        std::terminate();
    }
};
int Generator::value() {
    return coro.promise().current_value;
}
```

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```
Generator myGenerator() {
    std::println("[Thread {}] Entering coroutine", std::this_thread::get_id());
    //int big[100]; //400 bytes extra
    co_yield 10;
    co_yield 20;
    co_return;
}

int main() {
    auto gen = myGenerator();
    while (gen.next()) {
        std::println("[Thread {}] Got value: {}", std::this_thread::get_id(), gen.value());
    }
    std::println("[Thread {}] Done", std::this_thread::get_id());
}
```

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```
//[Thread 126906408617792] [operator new] Allocating coroutine frame of size 432 bytes
[Thread 140313004930880] [operator new] Allocating coroutine frame of size 32 bytes
[Thread 140313004930880] promise_type constructed
[Thread 140313004930880] get_return_object()
[Thread 140313004930880] Generator constructed
[Thread 140313004930880] initial_suspend()
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): calling resume()
[Thread 140313004930880] Entering coroutine
[Thread 140313004930880] yield_value(10)
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): resume() returned
[Thread 140313004930880] Got value: 10
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): calling resume()
[Thread 140313004930880] yield_value(20)
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): resume() returned
[Thread 140313004930880] Got value: 20
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): calling resume()
[Thread 140313004930880] return_void()
[Thread 140313004930880] final_suspend()
[Thread 140313004930880] next(): resume() returned
[Thread 140313004930880] Done
[Thread 140313004930880] Generator destroyed
[Thread 140313004930880] promise_type destroyed
[Thread 140313004930880] [operator delete] Freeing coroutine frame of size 32 bytes
```

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lazy ranges vs coroutine

- If your iterator needs an explanatory comment --> Use a coroutine
- If your iterator is obvious at a glance --> Range is fine

```
std::generator<int> gen()
{
    for (int i = 0; i < 5; ++i)
        co_yield i;

    for (int j = 5; j <= 15; j += 2)
        co_yield j;

    co_return;
}
```

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```
struct iter {
    int current = 0;

    int operator*() const { return current; }

    iter& operator++() {
        if (current < 4)
            ++current;
        else
            current += 2;
        return *this;
    }

    bool operator!=(const iter&) const {
        return current <= 15;
    }
};
```

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coroutines/ex1.cpp

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co_await

Express async logic in sequential style, without blocking.

```
auto n = co_await async_read(socket, buf);
co_await async_write(socket, n);
```

- No callbacks
- Compiler builds the state machine (write after read)

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co_await suspends the coroutine until **something** is available.

```
int value = co_await something;
```

During suspension:

- coroutine state is stored in the coroutine frame
- coroutine can later be resumed where it left off
- execution returns to the caller (of the coroutine)

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Definitions

Type	Purpose
Awaiting coroutine	Type a **coroutine** can co_await on
Awaiter	Object that implements the await protocol
Awaitable	expression after co_await

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The awaitable

has a member operator co_await()

```
struct MyTask {
    auto operator co_await();
};
```

or there is a free operator co_await(MyTask)

```
auto operator co_await(MyTask);
```

or it already implements the Awaiter API directly

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An **awaiter** must provide three functions:

```
struct Awaiter {
   bool await_ready();          // run now or suspend?
   void await_suspend(h);       // called when suspending
   T await_resume();            // value returned to caller
};
```

Where h is a coroutine handle of the awaiting coroutine

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Awaiter protocol

Function	Purpose
await_ready()	return `true` to continue without suspension
await_suspend(handle)	executed when suspending (schedule, enqueue, etc.)
await_resume()	executed after resuming, returns result

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An awaiter can also be the awaitable

SimpleAwaitable implements the awaiter interface.

```
struct SimpleAwaitable {
    bool await_ready() {
        std::println("await_ready");
        return false;
    }
    void await_suspend(std::coroutine_handle<> h) {
        std::println("await_suspend");
        h.resume();
    }
    int await_resume() {
        std::println("await_resume");
        return 42;
    }
};
```

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```
std::generator<int> example() {
    int value = co_await SimpleAwaitable{};
    co_yield value;
}
```

```
await_ready
await_suspend
coroutine pauses
coroutine resumes
await_resume
co_yield
```

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The awaiter is really an interface on what to do when the coroutine is suspended

User defined suspension points:

```
co_await Awaitable{};
```

coroutine state diagram suspension points:

```
std::suspend_always initial_suspend() { return {}; }
std::suspend_always final_suspend() noexcept { return {}; }
```

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```
struct suspend_always
{
    constexpr bool await_ready() const noexcept { return false; }
    constexpr void await_suspend( std::coroutine_handle<> ) const noexcept {}
    constexpr void await_resume() const noexcept {}
}
struct suspend_never
{
    constexpr bool await_ready() const noexcept { return true; }
    constexpr void await_suspend( std::coroutine_handle<> ) const noexcept {}
    constexpr void await_resume() const noexcept {}
}
```

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Classic simple task impl

```
Task compute() {
    std::println("entered child task");
    co_return 42;
}

Task parent() {
    std::println("entered parent task");
    int v = co_await compute();
    std::println("result = {}", v);
    co_return 0;
}

int main()
{
    //cannot use co_await here, main() is not a coroutine.
    parent().start();
}
```

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```
struct Task { //The awaitable
    struct promise_type {
        std::optional<int> value;
        std::coroutine_handle<> continuation;
        Task get_return_object() {
            return Task{
                std::coroutine_handle<promise_type>::from_promise(*this)};
        }
        std::suspend_always initial_suspend() { return {}; }
        auto final_suspend() noexcept {
            struct Awaiter {
                promise_type* promise;
                bool await_ready() const noexcept { return false; }
                void await_suspend(std::coroutine_handle<>) const noexcept {
                    std::println("await_suspend");
                    if (promise->continuation){
                        std::println("resuming continuation");
                        promise->continuation.resume();
                    }
                }
                void await_resume() const noexcept {}
            };
            return Awaiter{this};
        }
        void return_value(int v) { value = v; }
        void unhandled_exception() { std::terminate(); }
    };
    std::coroutine_handle<promise_type> coro;
    void start() { coro.resume();}
    auto operator co_await() {
        struct Awaiter {
            std::coroutine_handle<promise_type> h;
            bool await_ready() { return false; }
            void await_suspend(std::coroutine_handle<> awaiting) {
                std::println("awaiting suspend");
                h.promise().continuation = awaiting;
                h.resume();
            }
            int await_resume() {
                std::println("awaiting resume");
                return *h.promise().value;
            }
        };
        return Awaiter{coro};
    }
    ~Task() { if (coro) coro.destroy(); }
};
```

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std::suspend_always is an awaitable like any other

```
SimpleTask other_coroutine() {
    std::cout << "  [other] running step 1\n";
    co_await std::suspend_always{};
    std::cout << "  [other] running step 2\n";
    co_await std::suspend_always{};
    std::cout << "  [other] finishing\n";
}
```

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coroutines/ex2.cpp

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Timer

```
Task example() {
    std::println("{}:Waiting 1s",getcurtime());
    co_await Timer{std::chrono::seconds(1)};
    std::println("{}:Done!",getcurtime());
    std::println("{}:Waiting 500 ms",getcurtime());
    co_await Timer{std::chrono::milliseconds(500)};
    std::println("{}:Done!",getcurtime());
}
```

```
00:00:15.061:Waiting 1s
00:00:16.061:Done!
00:00:16.061:Waiting 500 ms
00:00:16.561:Done!
```

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Awaitable timer class

```
class Timer {
public:
    explicit Timer(std::chrono::milliseconds dur)
        : duration(dur) {}
    bool await_ready() const noexcept {
        return duration.count() == 0;
    }
    void await_suspend(std::coroutine_handle<> h);
    void await_resume() const noexcept {}

private:
    std::chrono::milliseconds duration;
};
```

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coroutine h is the coroutine that waits for the timer to complete

```
void Timer::await_suspend(std::coroutine_handle<> h)
{
    int fd = timerfd_create(CLOCK_MONOTONIC, 0);
    if (fd < 0) {
        perror("timerfd_create");
        std::exit(1);
    }
    itimerspec spec{};
    spec.it_value.tv_sec = duration.count() / 1000;
    spec.it_value.tv_nsec = (duration.count() % 1000) * 1'000'000;

    if (timerfd_settime(fd, 0, &spec, nullptr) < 0) {
        perror("timerfd_settime");
        std::exit(1);
    }
    // tell loop to resume h when timer'fd' has completed
    getLoop().addTimer(fd, h);
}
```

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```cpp
// ---------------- Event Loop ----------------
class EventLoop {
public:
    EventLoop() { epfd = epoll_create1(0); }
    ~EventLoop() { close(epfd); }
    void addTimer(int fd, std::coroutine_handle<> h) {
        epoll_event ev{};
        ev.events = EPOLLIN;
        ev.data.fd = fd;
        epoll_ctl(epfd, EPOLL_CTL_ADD, fd, &ev);
        waiters.push_back({fd, h});
    }
    void run() {
        while (!waiters.empty()) {
            epoll_event ev{};
            int n = epoll_wait(epfd, &ev, 1, -1);
            if (n <= 0) continue;
            // find the waiter
            for (auto it = waiters.begin(); it != waiters.end(); ++it) {
                if (it->fd == ev.data.fd) {
                    uint64_t exp;
                    read(it->fd, &exp, sizeof(exp));
                    close(it->fd);
                    auto coro = it->h;
                    waiters.erase(it);
                    coro.resume();
                    break;
                }
            }
        }
    }
private:
    struct Waiter {
        int fd;
        std::coroutine_handle<> h;
    };
    int epfd;
    std::vector<Waiter> waiters;
};
```

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ex4.cpp

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